

Informational Text • Informational

Grade	1	Word Count	227
Lexile	470L	Multi-level	N/A
Learning A–Z	level H		

Refer to the Focus Question on page 2 of this title to guide discussion and support additional learning connected to the text.

This book for emergent readers shares concise and fascinating information about pocket parks. Placed on small lots of land, these parks are sometimes no bigger than a parking space. Large, colorful photographs feature pocket parks from across the United States.

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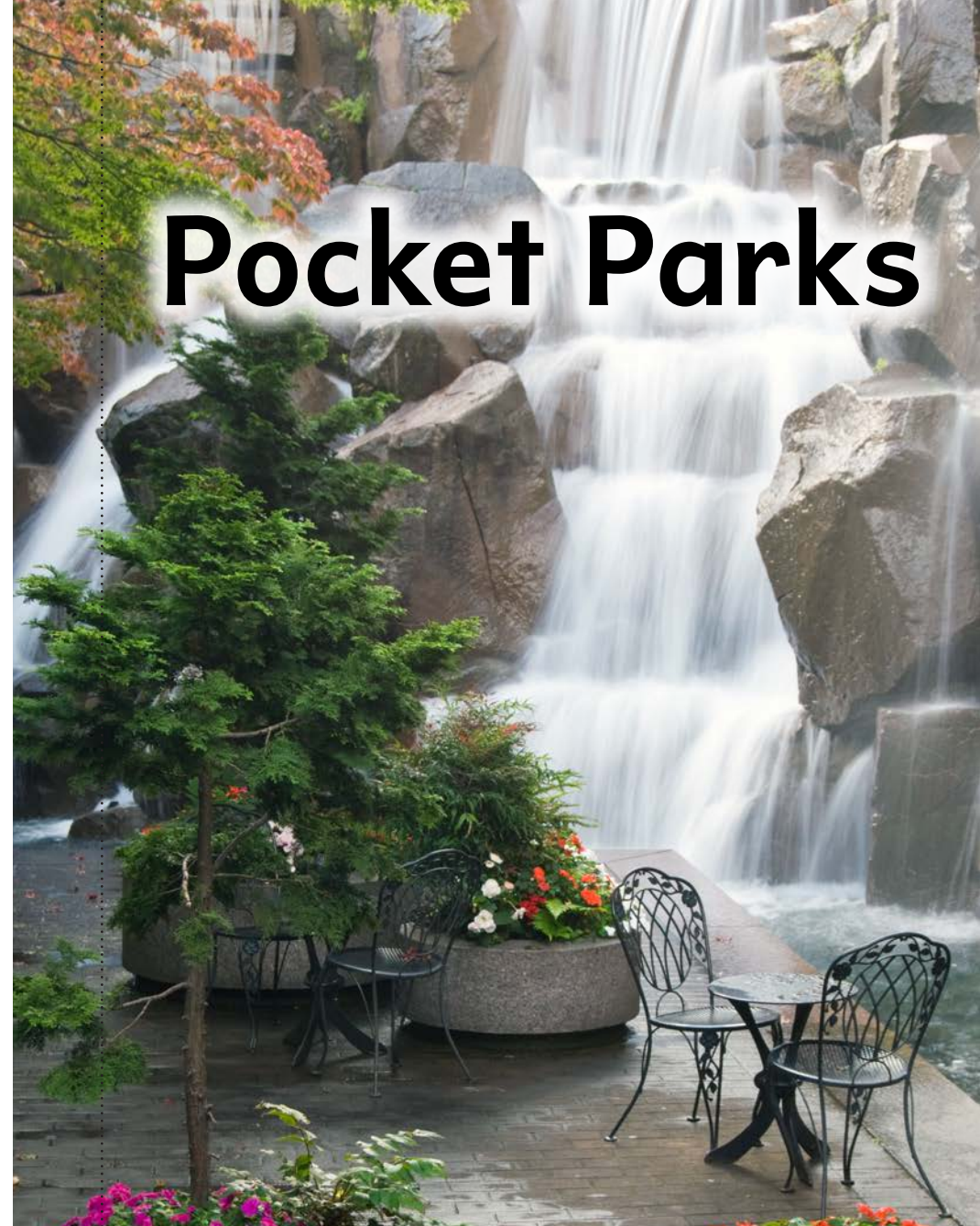
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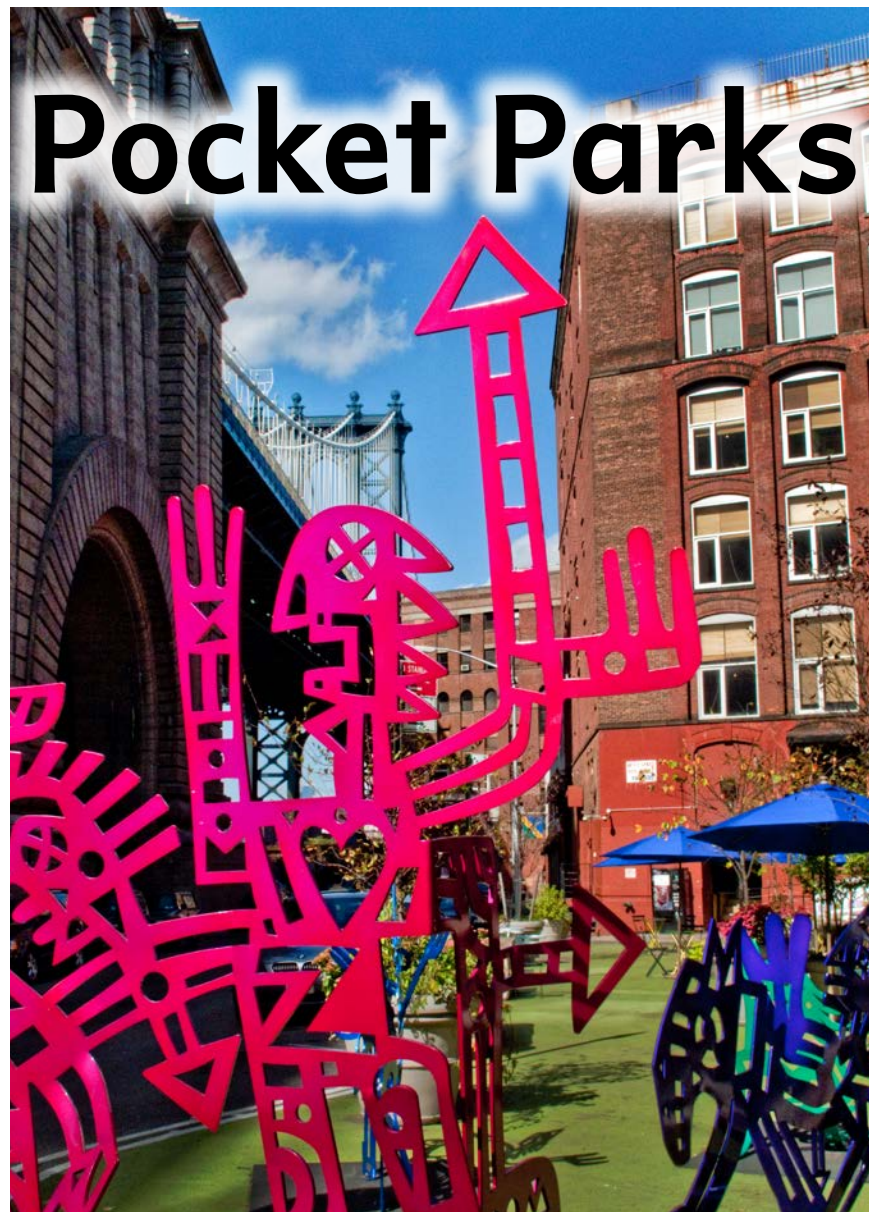
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Pocket Parks



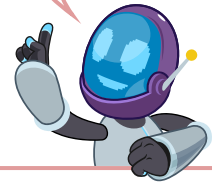
Written by Salomon Dunphy





Above: Pearl Street Pocket Park, New York City, New York
Cover: Waterfall Garden, Seattle, Washington

Focus Question
What are pocket parks?



Words to Know

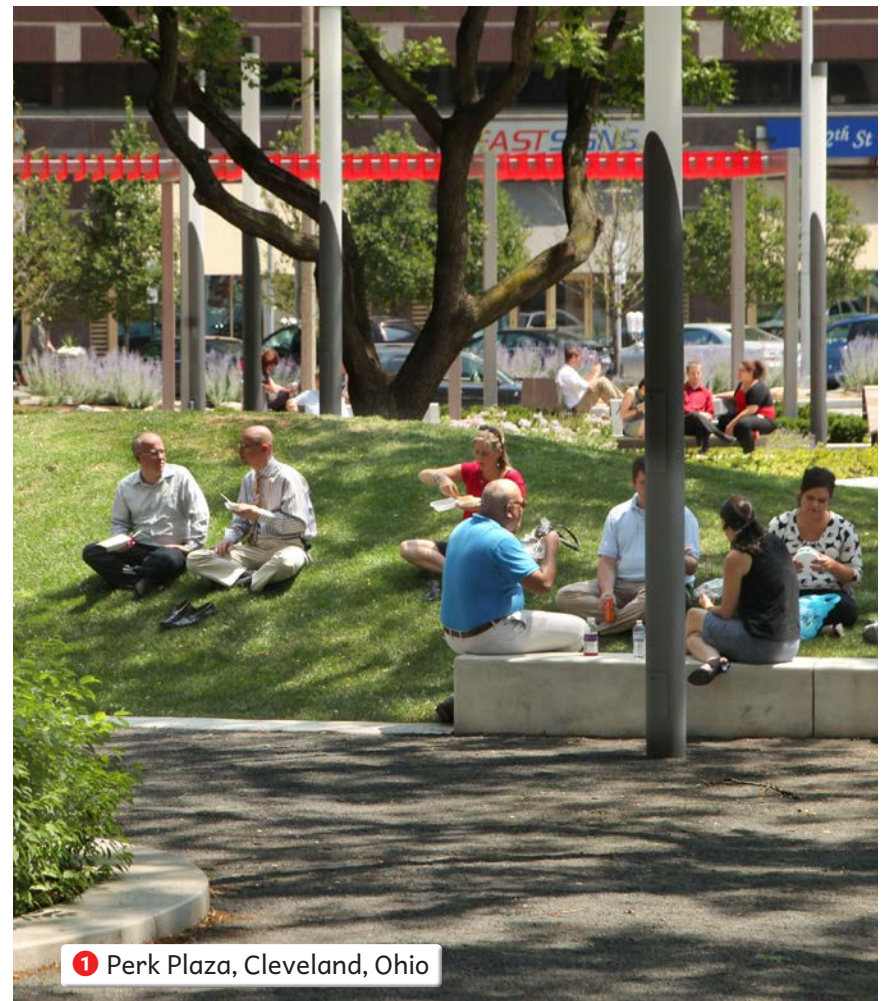
decorated	relax
lot	statue
pocket	waterfall



- | | |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| 1 Cleveland, Ohio | 5 St. Paul, Minnesota |
| 2 San Francisco, California | 6 Los Angeles, California |
| 3 New York City, New York | 7 Seattle, Washington |
| 4 Detroit, Michigan | 8 Boston, Massachusetts |

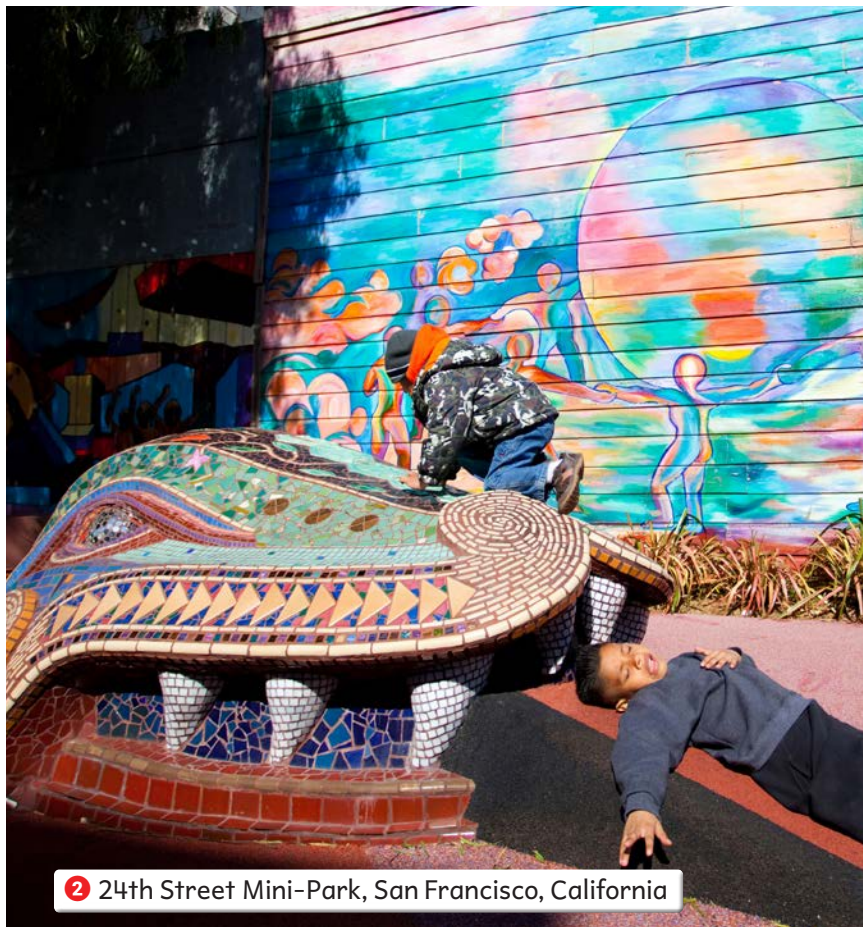
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What Is a Pocket Park?

Some cities don't have space for big, grassy parks. That's why they build **pocket parks** instead.



2 24th Street Mini-Park, San Francisco, California

A pocket park is like a regular park,
only smaller.

A pocket park can take up
a city block.

It can also be as small
as a parking space.

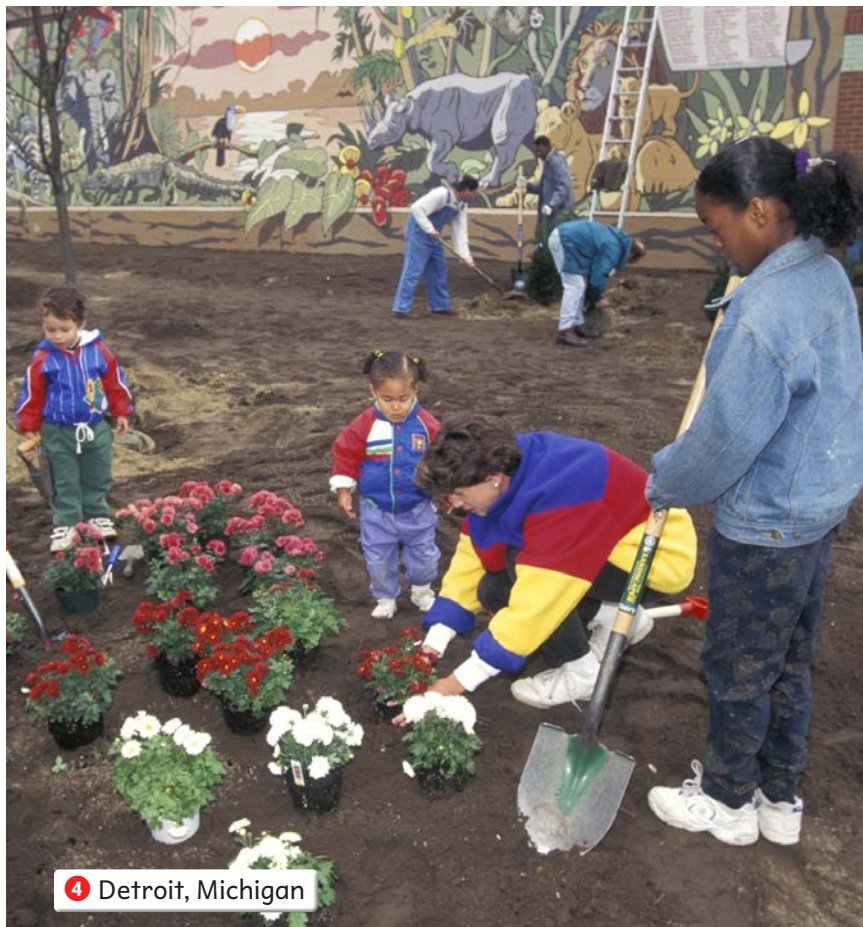


4 Detroit, Michigan

Lots of Empty Lots

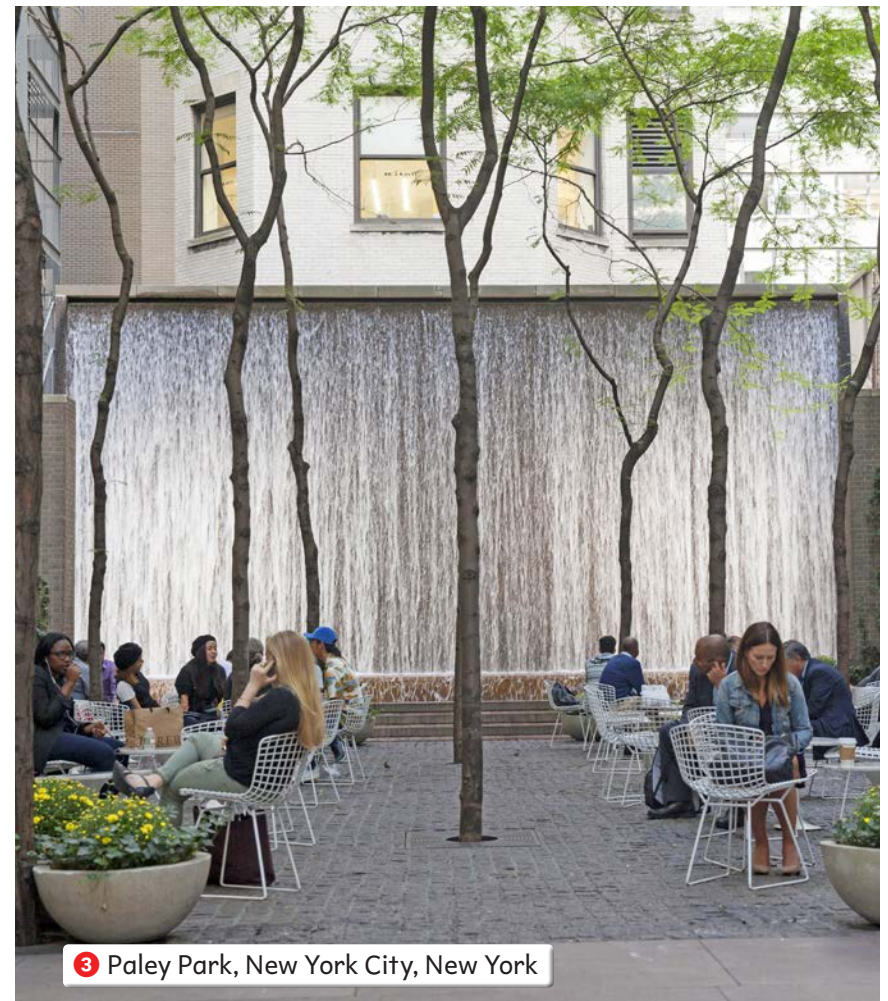
An empty **lot** is a great place
for a pocket park.

It can take many workers
to build one.



4 Detroit, Michigan

People who live close by
can help, too.
They can plant flowers or trees.
They can also help keep the park
clean and safe.
Every pocket park is different.



3 Paley Park, New York City, New York

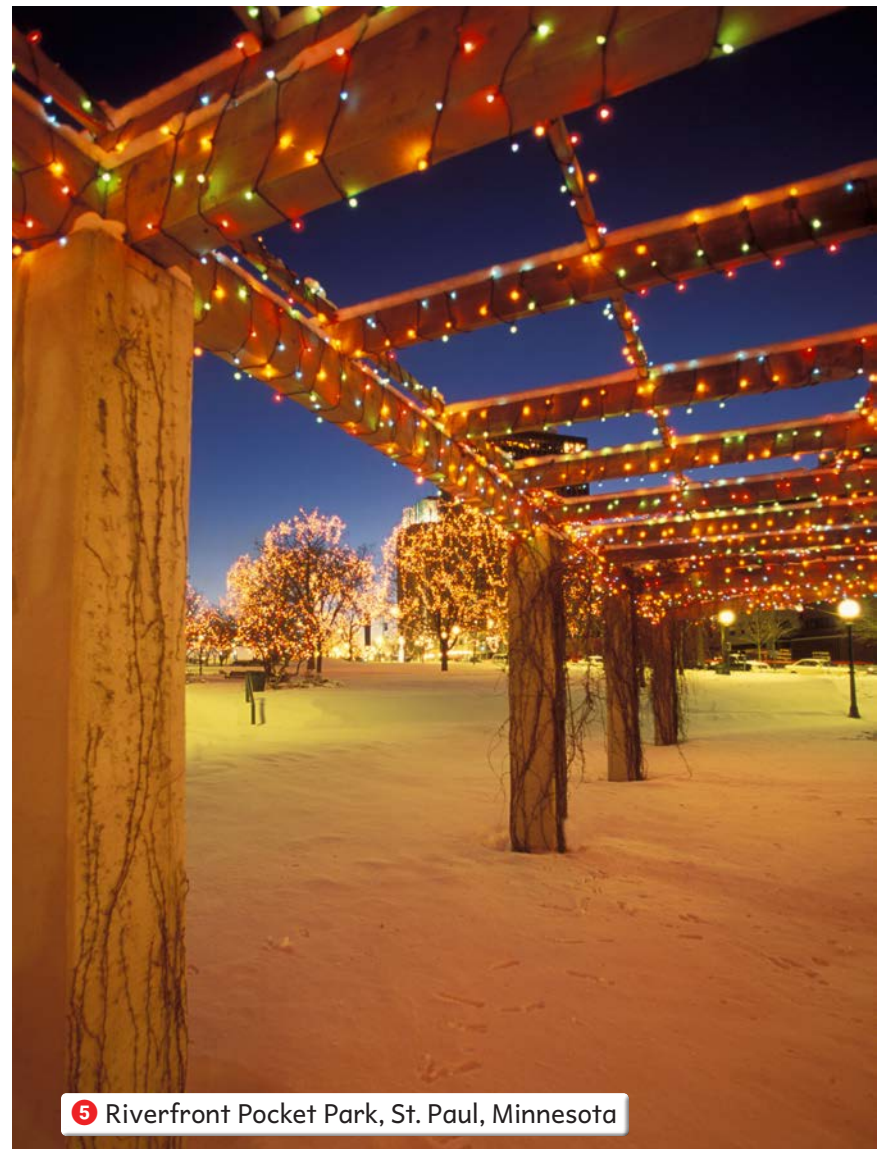
Different Pocket Parks

This pocket park has a **waterfall**
at the back.
It also has many places for people
to sit.



2 24th Street Mini-Park, San Francisco, California

Check out the colorful art at this pocket park.
It has a swing to play on, too.



5 Riverfront Pocket Park, St. Paul, Minnesota

People **decorated** this pocket park
with many lights.
They twinkle at night.



8 Harriet Tubman Memorial Park, Boston, Massachusetts

An artist made a **statue**
for this pocket park.
It reminds people of someone
important.



3 Laurie M. Tisch Illumination Park, New York City, New York

This pocket park has grass and
a large pond.
People can come here to think.



6 Marsh Park, Los Angeles, California

A man paints a big snake and turtle in this pocket park. They look as if they would be fun to play on.



7 Waterfall Garden Park, Seattle, Washington

This tiny pocket park is almost hidden in trees. People can **relax** and listen to the waterfall.



6 Marsh Park, Los Angeles, California

Conclusion

Pocket parks can be found all over.
Do you have a pocket park where
you live?

Glossary

decorated (v.) page 10

made something more attractive by
adding color or an ornament to it

lot (n.) page 6

a piece of land

pocket (n.) page 4

small areas of land parks used for play
and exercise

relax (v.) page 14

to spend time resting or doing things
for pleasure

statue (n.) page 11

a work of art, usually in the shape of
a person or other animal

waterfall (n.) page 8

a stream of water that falls over the edge
of something, especially from a high place